

Jess Hoi-Ki Law | 羅海琪

Stevenson 258
Department of Linguistics
UC Santa Cruz
Santa Cruz, CA 95064

EMAIL jesslaw@ucsc.edu
WEB <https://people.ucsc.edu/~jlaw5/>
G.SCHOLAR [here](#)

EMPLOYMENT

2019 - Present Assistant Professor
University of California, Santa Cruz

EDUCATION

2013 - 2019 PhD in Linguistics, Rutgers University
Dissertation: [Constraints on distributivity](#)
Committee: Simon Charlow (Co-Chair), Veneeta Dayal (Co-Chair),
Robert Henderson, Ken Safir

2011 - 2013 MPhil. in Linguistics, Chinese University of Hong Kong
MPhil Thesis: [Parasitic gaps in Mandarin](#)
Committee: Candice C.-H. Cheung (Chair), Thomas H.-T. Lee,
Lawrence Y.-L. Cheung, Marcel den Dikken

2007 - 2010 B.A. in Linguistics, Chinese University of Hong Kong

WORK IN PROGRESS

Status	Title	Avenue	Author(s)
In preparation	Monadic and dyadic final particles in Cantonese	TBD	Jess H.-K. Law Pranav Anand
In preparation	An AI-assisted multimodal approach to final particles in Mandarin	<i>Journal of Pragmatics</i>	Jess H.-K. Law Haoze Li
In preparation	An AI-assisted multimodal approach to negation and focus in English	<i>Corpus Pragmatics</i>	Jess H.-K. Law Pranav Anand Haoze Li
Submitted	Experimental evidence for distinct anaphoric potentials of indefinites and	<i>Glossa Psycholinguistics</i>	Jess H.-K. Law Ziling Zhu

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Year	Title	Journal	Author(s)
2026	Final particles in Cantonese	<i>New Perspectives in Chinese Semantics</i> , Routledge	Jess H.-K. Law
2026	An experimental investigation of the role of pragmatics in focus intervention effects in Mandarin	<i>Journal of East Asian Linguistics</i>	Jess H.-K. Law Yaqing Cao Haoze Li
2025	An affectedness approach to Mandarin passives	<i>Journal of East Asian Linguistics</i>	Jess H.-K. Law Colin Hirschberg
2024	Force shift: a case study of Cantonese <i>ho2</i> particle clusters	<i>Natural Language Semantics</i>	Jess H.-K. Law Diti Bhadra Haoze Li
2023	A New Corpus of Lexical Substitution and Word Blend Errors: Probing the Semantic Structure of Lemma Access Failures	<i>Journal of Cognition</i>	JohnAlderete Melissa Baese-Berk Adrian Brasoveanu Jess H.-K. Law
2022	The mereological structure of distributivity: a case study of binominal <i>each</i>	<i>Journal of Semantics</i>	Jess H.-K. Law
2016	Alternatives in different dimensions: A case study of focus intervention	<i>Linguistics & Philosophy</i>	Haoze Li Jess H.-K. Law

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Year	Title	Proceeding	Author(s)
2024	Do we need two uniqueness conditions? A reply to Lewis (2022)	Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 29	Jess H.-K. Law Haoze Li
2018	Questioning speech acts	Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 22	Haoze Li Diti Bhadra
2017	Experimental evidence for the discourse potential of bare nouns in Mandarin	Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of	Jess H.-K. Law Kristen Syrett

Year	Title	Proceeding	Author(s)
		North East Linguistic Society (NELS 47)	
2017	The number sensitivity of modal indefinites	Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 21 (SuB 21)	Jess H.-K. Law
2017	At least some distributive items aren't distributive items	Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 46)	Haoze Li Jess H.-K. Law

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Year	Title	Conference	Author(s)
2025	Cantonese particle <i>aa3</i> as a marker of illocutionary distance	International Pragmatics Conference 19, University of Queensland, Brisbane	Jess H.-K. Law Pranav Anand
2024	Do we need two uniqueness conditions?	Sinn und Bedeutung 29	Jess H.-K. Law Haoze Li
2023	Affectedness in passives	The 13th Workshop on Theoretical East Asian Linguistics	Jess H.-K. Law Colin Hirschberg
2022	Focus intervention effects in Mandarin	The 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 35)	Yaqing Cao Jess H.-K. Law
2019	Independence in distributivity	The 29th annual meeting of Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT 29)	Jess H.-K. Law
2019	Experimental support for discourse translucency of bare noun phrases in Mandarin	The 92nd Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA 92)	Jess H.-K. Law Kristen Syrett

2018	Monotonicity in distributivity with binominal each	The 49th Annual Meeting of North East Linguistic Society	Jess H.-K. Law
2017	Questioning Speech Acts	Sinn und Bedeutung 22 (SuB 22)	Jess H.-K. Law Diti Bhadra Haoze Li
2016	Experimental evidence for the discourse potential of bare nouns	The 47th annual meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 47)	Jess H.-K. Law Kristen Syrett
2016	The number sensitivity of modal indefinites	Sinn und Bedeutung 21 (SuB 21)	Jess H.-K. Law
2015	At least some distributive operators aren't distributive operators.	The 46th annual meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 46)	Haoze Li Jess H.-K. Law
2014	Focus intervention effects and the quantificational domains of focus-sensitive operators	The 37th annual meeting of Generative Linguistics in Old World (GLOW 37)	Haoze Li Jess H.-K. Law
2013	Focus intervention effects	The 44th annual meeting of North East Linguistic Society (NELS 44)	Haoze Li Jess H.-K. Law

GRANTS/HONORS/AWARDS

Year	Project	Agency	Amount
2025 - 2027	A multimodal approach to discourse particles (PI)	COR Large Grant	USD11,000
2024 - 2025	Developing an online course based on Semantics 1 (Co-PI)	Online Course Development Award	USD40,000

2021 - 2022	A trans-Pacific collaborative course on Chinese languages (PI)	Global Classroom Award (UCSC)	USD4,000
2020 - 2022	Diagnosing the variation inference of 'each' (PI)	COR Faculty Research Grant	USD2,500
2020 - 2021	Designing an asynchronous online course to teach introductory linguistics (PI)	Online Course Development Award	USD4,000
2019 - 2020	Speech acts in particle languages (PI)	New Faculty Research Grant	USD1,145

INVITED TALKS

Year	Title	Institute/organization	Date
2025	Cantonese particle <i>aa3</i> as a marker of illocutionary distance	National University of Singapore	August 1, 2025
2024	Confirmational questions: bias and degrees of assertability	ZAS, Berlin, Germany	June 28, 2024
2024	The role of context in intervention effects	National University of Singapore	September 11, 2024
2024	Bare nouns in Mandarin as weak definites: Experimental evidence & theoretical implications	Nanyang Technological University, Singapore	August 30, 2024
2024	Confirmational questions as a window into dynamic force determination	Fudan University, Shanghai, China	April 18, 2024
2023	Two types of force shifts	Georgetown University, USA	April 25, 2023
2022	To perform or not to perform a speech act	Edinburgh University, UK	April 14, 2022
2021	Building complex speech acts	Zhejiang University, China	November 25, 2021
2021	Building complex speech acts	University of California, Los Angeles	November 12, 2021

2020	Questioning speech acts	Stanford University	January 17, 2020
2019	Constraints on distributivity	UC Santa Cruz	January, 2019

TEACHING

2025 - 2026	Course	Enrollment	Level
Fall 2025	Semantics 1 (LING53)	70	UG
Winter 2026	Course release		
Spring 2026	Introduction to Linguistics (LING50)	117	UG
	Semantics 3: A multimodal approach to meaning (LING118)	3	UG
2024 - 2025	Course	Enrollment	Level
Fall 2024	Semantics A (LING231)	10	PG
Winter 2025	Semantics 2 (LING116)	26	UG
	Senior Research	10	UG
Spring 2025	Course release		
2023 - 2024	Course	Enrollment	Level
Fall 2023	Course release		
Winter 2024	Semantics 1 (LING53)	121	UG
	Semantics Seminar (LING239)	2	PG
Spring 2024	Pragmatics (LING117)	12	UG
	Senior Research (LING190)	1	UG
2022 - 2023	Course	Enrollment	Level
Fall 2022	Pragmatics (LING117)	29	UG

	Semantics A (LING231)	5	PG
	Senior Thesis (LING195)	1	UG
	Senior Research	6	UG
Winter 2023	Semantics I (LING53)	82	UG
	Senior Thesis (LING195)	1	UG

Spring 2023

Sabbatical leave

Summer 2023	Semantics I (LING53)	17	UG
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2021 - 2022	Course	Enrollment	Level
Fall 2021	Structure of Chinese Languages (LING188)	21	UG
	Semantics A (LING231)	10	PG
	Senior Research (LING195)	6	UG
Winter 2022	Semantics 2 (LING116)	45	UG
	Senior Research (LING195)	7	UG
	Tutorial (LING199F)	1	UG
	Independent Study (LING297A)	2	PG
Spring 2022	Senior Thesis (LING195)	1	UG
	Independent Study (LING297A)	1	PG
Summer 2022	Intro to Linguistics (LING50)	45	UG

2020 - 2021	Course	Enrollment	Level
Fall 2020	Independent Study (LING297A)	1	PG
Winter 2021	Semantics 2 (LING116)	52	UG
Spring	Semantics B (LING232)	4	PG

2019 - 2020	Course	Enrollment	Level
Fall	Semantics Seminar (LING239)	5	PG
Winter	Semantics 2 (LING116)	48	UG
Spring	Introduction to Linguistics (LING50)	212	UG, online
Summer	Science of Language (LING80S)	43	UG

ADVISING

Student	Type of research	Role	Year
Alan Yan, Maria Ralph, Amelia Delso	Class project	Adviser	Spring 2026
Raphael Ostrowski, Makua Nibo	Research Fellow	Adviser	Spring 2026
Emily Knick	Qualifying Paper	Member	2025 - 2026
Emma Smith	Qualifying Paper	Member	2025 - 2026
Jun Tamura	Dissertation	Member	2023 - 2025
Sadira Lewis	BA Thesis	Chair	2022 - 2023
Thesis title: <i>Experimental investigation of the -er morphology and the eventive interpretation</i>			
Thesis Award: Koret Scholars (2022-23)			
Eli Sharf	Qualifying paper	Member	2022 - 2023
Delaney Jackson-Gomez	MA Thesis	Member	2022 - 2023
Colin Hirschberg	BA Thesis	Chair	2021 - 2022
Thesis title: <i>Restrictions on Mandarin bei-passives</i>			
Thesis Award: Dean's Award (2022-23)			
Taijing Xiao	MA Thesis	Chair	2021 - 2023
Thesis title: <i>Argument reversals in Mandarin</i>			
Yaqing Cao	Qualifying Paper	Chair	2020 - 2022
Project title: <i>An experimental study of focus intervention effects in Mandarin</i>			
Poster presented at the 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 35)			

	Qualifying Paper	Member	2021 - 2022
	Qualifying Exam	Member	2022 - 2023
Lisa Hofmann	Dissertation	Member	2020 - 2022
Andrew Hedding	Qualifying Exam	Member	2019 - 2023
Jack Duff	Qualifying Paper	Member	2019 - 2020
Anelia Kudin	Qualifying Paper	Member	2019 - 2020
Jeremie Beauchamp	Qualifying Paper	Member	2019 - 2020

DEPARTMENTAL/CAMPUS SERVICES

2025 - 2026	Events Committee (Colloquia, annual UG conference, graduate recruitment events, etc)	Co-Chair
2024 - 2025	Fusional Linguistics Initiative	Organizer
2021 - 2023	The annual Linguistics Undergraduate Research Conference	Coordinator
2021 - 2023	The program learning outcomes unit	Coordinator

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Chair of Program Committee, [41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics](#) (2023)

Journal reviewer

Glossa

Journal of Semantics

Language and Linguistics

Natural Language Semantics

Linguistics & Philosophy

Conference abstract reviewer

The International Conference on Head-Driven Phrase Structure Grammar (HPSG, 2025)

Human Sentence Processing (HSP, 2022)

Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM, 2022)

Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT, 2020, 2023)

North East Linguistic Society (NELS, 2020)

Semantics & Pragmatics

Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning
(MACSIM, 2015-2017)

Studies in Chinese Linguistics

SKILLS

Natural language skills

Cantonese (native)

Mandarin (near native)

Hakka (native, heritage)

English (proficient)

Japanese (basic)

Spanish (basic)

Professional skills

R (Statistical Programming)

Python

PCIBex (for linguistic experimentation)

Latex

ELAN (for multimodal analysis)